CBSE CLASS 10 ENGLISH (FIRST FLIGHT)

CHAPTER-WISE QUESTION BANK: MIJBIL THE OTTER

Time Allowed: 1.5 Hours | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION A: MULTIPLE CHOICE QUESTIONS (1 Mark Each)

Q1. Why did Gavin Maxwell think Camusfearna would be an eminently suitable spot for an 'experiment' to keep an otter?
(a) The climate was warm and tropical.
(b) It was a stone's throw from the door and surrounded by water.
(c) It was far away from the local town and human disturbance.
(d) Local villagers highly recommended otters over watchdogs.

Q2. What was the immediate behavioral reaction of the otter upon entering Maxwell's room in Basra?
(a) He jumped onto the bed and began playing with the sheets.
(b) He went wild with joy and began plunging into water.
(c) He was neither hostile nor friendly, staying aloof and indifferent on the floor.
(d) He immediately attached himself to Maxwell's feet seeking security.

Q3. Which of the following words correctly identifies the meaning of 'engrossed' as used in reference to Mijbil's behavior with his toys?
(a) Distracted
(b) Indifferent
(c) Fully absorbed
(d) Aggressive

Q4. Why did Maxwell have to travel to Paris on his way back to London?
(a) He wanted to take Mijbil on a brief European holiday.
(b) British Airlines refused to fly animals, forcing him to choose another airline.
(c) The local airport at Basra was under repair.
(d) His friend was waiting to collect his mail from the Paris terminal.

Q5. What was the most absurd or wild guess a Londoner made about Mijbil's species?
(a) A domestic cat
(b) A baby seal
(c) A brontosaur
(d) A small squirrel

SECTION B: EXTRACT-BASED COMPETENCY QUESTIONS (4 Marks Each)

Extract 1: Read the passage given below and answer the questions that follow:

"When I returned, there was an appalling spectacle. There was complete silence from the box, but from its airholes and chinks around the lid, a trickle of dried blood had turned to a thick crust. I whipped off the lock and

tore open the flaps, and Mij, exhausted and blood-spattered, whimpered and caught at my leg. He had torn the lining of the box to shreds; when I removed the last of it so that there were no sharp edges left, it was just ten minutes until the time of the flight..."

(i) What does the expression 'appalling spectacle' refer to in the context of the extract?

(ii) Why did the otter tear the internal lining of the box to pieces?

(iii) State whether the following statement is TRUE or FALSE:
Maxwell was furious at the otter for delaying his flight itinerary.

(iv) Find a word from the extract that means the same as 'cried softly out of pain or fear'.

Extract 2: Read the passage given below and answer the questions that follow:

"The air hostess was the very queen of her kind. I took her into my confidence about the events of the last half-hour. She suggested that I might prefer to have my pet on my knee, and I could have kissed her hand in the depth of my gratitude. But, not knowing otters, I was quite unprepared for what followed. Mij was out of the box in a flash. He disappeared at high speed down the aircraft..."

(i) Why does Maxwell refer to the air hostess as 'the very queen of her kind'?

(ii) What immediate disaster occurred right after the narrator opened the travel box?

(iii) Which emotion best describes Maxwell's feeling when the hostess gave her suggestion?
(a) Fear (b) Indifference (c) Deep gratitude (d) Arrogance

(iv) Explain how the phrase 'out of the box in a flash' highlights Mijbil's natural characteristics.

SECTION C: SHORT ANSWER TYPE QUESTIONS (3 Marks Each - 40-50 Words)

Q6. Why did Gavin Maxwell have to wait for five days in Basra to receive his mail? Explain the difficulties he faced.

Q7. Describe the ritual or character trait that Maxwell refers to as the 'real play' of an otter. How did Mijbil demonstrate this trait?

Q8. What happened when Mijbil escaped into the passenger cabin of the aircraft? How was he finally retrieved?

Q9. How did Mijbil behave when he was first taken to the bathroom? What does this reveal about his natural environment?

SECTION D: LONG ANSWER TYPE QUESTIONS (6 Marks Each - 100-120 Words)

Q10. [Value-Based] Responsibility and empathy are fundamental requirements when choosing to domesticate a wild animal. Elaborate on this theme by critically evaluating Gavin Maxwell's attitude and actions toward Mijbil throughout their turbulent journey from Basra to London.

Q11. [Creativity & Insight] Imagine you are the air hostess on the flight from Paris to London. You were deeply touched by the passenger's devotion to his injured pet and your timely intervention saved the cabin from mass panic. Write a diary entry detailing your experience of handling 'Maxwell's Otter' mid-flight.